

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in legal administration, case file management and client communication, gained at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Adobe. At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team, maintained matter records on iManage, prepared electronic hearing bundles, handled court filings and tracked deadlines across several concurrent matters. Currently advising clients at Citizens Advice East Berkshire across housing, debt and employment matters: takes instructions, drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and manages case files from instruction to submission. Looking for a legal secretary or legal assistant role where strong organisational skills and experience of managing busy caseloads can be put to immediate use.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients across housing, welfare benefits, employment, debt and family matters; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Translates complex procedural rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials across several concurrent matters
- Maintained matter records on iManage; handled court filings, hearing arrangements and matter opening and closure
- Tracked deadlines and managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing matters
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes; prepared client notes

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration

- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions to support on-time submission shortly before a significant deadline
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations and drafted clear, commercially focused advice for a data-driven start-up
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; flagged contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Case file organisation and maintenance; deadline tracking across concurrent matters; hearing bundle preparation; court filings; procedural document drafting; confidential document handling